Using Pry to Troubleshoot Test Failures

Pry is really a wonderful console, but again, this is *Rails 5 Test Prescriptions* not *Rails 5 Console Prescriptions*. Luckily, you can invoke Pry directly from inside a test.

If you add the line binding.pry to your code, then a Pry session will start when the code execution reaches that line.

Let's see how this works. I'll put a binding.pry in one of the tests in the action test file creates_project_test.rb. Can you guess which line from this session trace contains binding.pry?

```
$ rspec
.....................................................
From: .../spec/workflows/creates_project_spec.rb @ line 12 :

     7:
     8:   describe "initialization" do
     9:     let(:task_string) { "" }
    10:     it "creates a project given a name" do
    11:       creator.build
 => 12:       binding.pry
    13:       expect(creator.project.name).to eq("Project Runway")
    14:     end
    15:   end
    16:

[1] pry(#<RSpec::ExampleGroups::CreatesProject::Initialization>)>
```

Pry not only opens a session; it displays the test where it stopped, and it sets the Pry scope to the test class (again, this is syntax-highlighted).

You can use the cd notation to see what's going on:

```
[1] pry(#<CreatesProjectTest>)> cd creator
[2] pry(#<CreatesProject>):1> ls
ActiveSupport::ToJsonWithActiveSupportEncoder#methods: to_json
CreatesProject#methods:
  build create  name=    project=  success?     task_string=  users=
  convert_string_to_tasks  name    project  size_as_integer  task_string  users
self.methods: __pry__
instance variables: @name  @project  @success  @task_string  @users
locals: _  __  _dir_  _ex_  _file_  _in_  _out_  _pry_
[3] pry(#<CreatesProject>):1> cd project
[6] pry(#<Project>):2> name
=> "Project Runway"
```

And then, if you use <control>-c to exit Pry, the tests just continue on their merry way.